

Alert properties (task 3): -

Now you know how alerts are generated, it's time to review their content. While details differ for every SIEM or Security Solution, the alerts generally have few main properties you must understand before taking them. Don't worry if you find some confusing, as you will hear more about some in upcoming tasks.

Time	Name	Severity	Status	Verdict	Assignee	Actions
Mar 21st 2025 at 11:53	Brute Force Attack from External	Medium	Closed	✓ True Positive	J.Adams (J2)	
Mar 21st 2025 at 13:58	Double-Extension File Creation	High	Awaiting action	None	None	

Description:	
Host:	LPT-HR-009
Process Name:	chrome.exe
Process User:	S.Conway
Target File:	C:\Users\S.Conway\Downloads\cats2025.mp4.exe
File MD5:	https://freecatvids.hd.monster/cats2025.mp4.exe
File MD5:	14d8486f3f3875e93c6d240c5c10b

Alert properties: -

No	property	Description	Example
1.	Alert time	Shows alert creation time. Alerts usually trigger a few minutes after the actual event	Alert time: ~ March 21, 15:35 Event time: ~ March 21, 15:32
2.	Alert Name	Provides a summary of what happened, based on detection rule's name	Unusual login location & email marked as phishing Windows RDP Brute Force & potential data exfiltration
3.	Alert severity	Defines the urgency of alert, initially set by detection engineers, but can be altered by analysts if needed.	(●) Low / Informational (●) Medium / Moderate (●) High / Severe (●) Critical / Urgent
4.	Alert Status	Informs if somebody is working on alert or if triage is done	(■) New / Unassigned (■) In Progress / Pending (■) Closed / Resolved - And often other custom statuses
5.	Alert verdict	Also called alert classification, explains if alert is real threat or noise.	(●) - True positive / real threat (●) - False positive / No threat - And often custom verdict
6.	Alert Assignee	Shows the analyst that was assigned or assigned themselves to review alert	- Assign can sometimes be called alert owner - Assign takes responsibility for this alert
7.	Alert Description	Explains what alert is about, usually in 3 sections on right	- The logic of alert generating rule. - Why this activity can indicate an attack - Optionally, how to triage this alert
8.	Alert fields	Provides SOC analyst comments and values on which alert was triggered	Affected host name & entered commandline & And many more, depending on alert

Alert prioritisation: -

Okay now we can read and understand the alert. What's next? Recall the second task, when you see hundreds of alerts but have to choose which to pick up first. The process of deciding which to take is called **Alert Prioritisation**, and it's crucial to ensure timely detection of threats. Especially



with many alerts in queue.

Picking the Right Alert: -

Every SOC team decides on its own prioritisation rules and usually automates them by setting the appropriate alert sorting logic in SIEM or EDR. Below may see generic, simplest and most commonly used approach:-

1. Filter the alerts :- Make sure you don't take alert that other analysts have already reviewed, or that is already being investigated by one of your teammates. You should only take new, yet unseen and unresolved alerts.

2. Sort by severity: -

Start with critical alerts, then high, medium and finally low. This is because detection engineers design rules so that critical alerts are much more likely to be real, major threats and cause more impact than medium or low ones.

3. Sort by time: -

Start with oldest alerts and end with the newest ones. The idea is if both alerts are about breaches, the hacker from older breach is likely already dumping your data, while the "newcomer" has just started the directory.

Quiz: -

1) Should you first prioritise medium over low severity alerts? (Yea/Nay)

A) Yea

2) Should you first take newest alerts and then the older ones? (Yea/Nay)

A) Nay